



Values Audit



Values are powerful principles or qualifications that underpin our actions and our opinions about events and people. Sometimes they are called ‘critical needs’.

Values change significantly over the years and it’s important to be clear about them and to better assess how they can be met. Decisions we make often reflect what’s important in our lives. If there’s a conflict between a decision and your own values, very often this conflict can contribute to both personal and career dissatisfaction and unhappiness.

Sources of strong dissatisfaction often occur when we have cherished values that are not currently being acted on or when we have two strong values that are in conflict, such as a desire for achievement and leisure. Often we’re not fully aware of values that drive us, especially if they have always been satisfied.

Values Audit Exercise

Directions

1. Review each of the values listed below. You will select from one of four columns: **Always Valued**, **Often Valued**, **Sometimes Valued** and **Rarely Valued**.
2. Check the column that best describes how important each value is to you right now at this point in your life. Consider your choices carefully and use **all** of the columns.
3. Please do not exceed 10 checks in the **Always Valued** column.

		Always Valued	Often Valued	Sometimes Valued	Rarely Valued
1	Personal Growth: Develop my potential and use my talents				
2	Achievement: Have a sense of accomplishment				
3	Knowledge: Develop and use specific knowledge				
4	Status: Hold a position of recognised importance				
5	Change and Variety: Have job responsibilities with varied tasks				
6	Service to Society: Contribute to a better society				
7	Physical Activity: Do work requiring strength, agility, or physical exertion				
8	Independence: Control my own work/schedule				
9	Leadership: Influence others to achieve results				
10	Creative Expression: Express my creativity and imagination in my work				
11	Challenge: Find work that stimulates me mentally				
12	Money: Reap significant financial rewards in my work				
13	Security: Perform my work without worry about possible unemployment				

		Always Valued	Often Valued	Sometimes Valued	Rarely Valued
14	Management: Achieve work goals as a result of others' efforts				
15	Work with Others: Belong to a satisfying work				
16	Power: Have control over resources at work				
17	Integrity: Work ethically and honestly				
18	Balance: Achieve the right proportion between my personal life and professional responsibilities				
19	Friendship: Develop social/personal friendships with work colleagues				
20	Career Advancement: Have opportunities within the organisation				
21	Detail Work: Deal with tasks that must meet specifications requiring careful, accurate attention to detail				
22	Fast Pace: Work under time-pressured circumstances with demanding expectations				
23	Helping Others: Involve myself in helping society and others				
24	Location: Live in a convenient geographic location in a suitable community				
25	Recognition: Receive credit for work well-done				
26	Excitement: Frequent novelty and drama				
27	Moral Fulfilment: Work contributes to moral ideals				
28	Aesthetics: Appreciate the beauty of things and ideas				
29	Health: Being physically and mentally fit				
30	Positive Atmosphere: Work in a supportive, pleasing, harmonious setting				
31	Efficient Organisation: Being in a time-efficient environment with little bureaucracy				
32	Family Happiness: Good balance between work and family life				

Your Priority Values

A forced ranking of values helps you to clarify the trade-offs necessary to fulfill your most important needs.

Directions

Write your Always Valued items in the first column below.

1. Rank order your Top 7 values in the second column.
2. Now, look at your Top 7 priority values individually. Were these values fulfilled in your existing or past work roles?
3. If you are considering accepting an offer are your values likely to be fulfilled?

Critical Values	Priority Ranking 1-7	Fulfilled in existing/ past roles			Likely to be fulfilled in future roles		
		Current role	Past role 1	Past role 2	Role 1	Role 2	Role 3

Career Anchors and Values Alignment

Below are some values that are typically associated with Career Anchors. Examine the relationship between your priority values and your Career Anchor to obtain additional valuable insights. Look for patterns and inconsistencies between the two sets of data.

Technical/Functional Competence

- ▶ Personal Growth
- ▶ Achievement
- ▶ Knowledge
- ▶ Status
- ▶ Detail Work
- ▶ Recognition

General Managerial Competence

- ▶ Achievement
- ▶ Status
- ▶ Leadership
- ▶ Money Management
- ▶ Power
- ▶ Career Advancement
- ▶ Recognition

Autonomy/Independence

- ▶ Change and Variety
- ▶ Independence
- ▶ Efficient Organisation

Security/Stability

- ▶ Security
- ▶ Money
- ▶ Friendship
- ▶ Work with Others
- ▶ Location

Entrepreneurial Creativity

- ▶ Achievement
- ▶ Independence
- ▶ Creative Expression
- ▶ Money

Service/Dedication to a Cause

- ▶ Service to Society
- ▶ Integrity
- ▶ Helping Others
- ▶ Moral Fulfilment

Pure Challenge

- ▶ Personal Growth
- ▶ Change & Variety
- ▶ Physical Activity
- ▶ Leadership
- ▶ Challenge
- ▶ Fast Pace
- ▶ Excitement
- ▶ Efficient Organisation
- ▶ Achievement

Lifestyle

- ▶ Balance
- ▶ Work with Others
- ▶ Money
- ▶ Friendship
- ▶ Location
- ▶ Aesthetics
- ▶ Health
- ▶ Positive Atmosphere
- ▶ Family Happiness